Bing's new logo
Bing has updated its logo by capitalising the "b" and changing its colour to green, to show more commitment to search **http://dgit.in/NewBingLogo**

Music Memo and more
Apple's focusing on sound, launched Music memos — it lets musicians record and share ideas! **http://dgit.in/iMusicMemo**

UNDERSTANDING DISPLAY SYNC

V-Sync wasn't good enough when it came to dealing with screen tearing and dropping frame rates in graphics intensive games for a long time. It was only a matter of time until the rise of other advanced sync services like G-Sync, V-Sync and Adaptive Sync. All sync forces the video display to adapt to the rendering frame rate of source rather than, source adapting to display refresh rate. Makes total sense, doesn't it? Good.

FreeSync Vs. G-Sync

G-Sync is a sync standard introduced by NVIDIA for its GPUs while FreeSync is the AMD counterpart. FreeSync to some extent was created on the same framework and architecture as VESA Adaptive Sync, but the basic difference between these is the DisplayPort protocol. While Adaptive Sync used to require eDP 1.2a support, FreeSync worked fine with DP 1.2. But now all the displays come with eDP 1.2a protocol, so no issues as earlier.

FreeSync is free to use, open source with no legal penance and with a dynamic refresh rate of 9-240 Hz. . G-Sync is more on the proprietary side with it's own LCD scaler, otherwise known as field-programmable gate array (or FPGA) which raises the display's cost. AMD on the other hand tied up with known LCD scaler manufacturers to maintain its royalty-free status. Both these methods of sync make a noticeable difference to frame rate quality, we've noticed. In this test itself, we saw monitors with G-Sync and FreeSync were a cut above the rest in terms of overall gaming performance.

The build quality of the BenQ XL series of monitors is pretty good, nothing to complain. The thing that attracted us the most would be separate controllers for OSD controls on all the XL series units, which seems to be exclusive to these monitors.

In terms of performance, highlights, we must say that the BenQ XL2430T excelled over all the rest of the monitors in two key areas – it had the highest white point value, with respect to its gamut, in our Datacolor Spyder test and it also had the highest white saturation value on Lagom.nl LCD's benchmark. It is yet another shining star and a feather in the cap of BenQ.

BenQ XL2730Z

Acer XB240H

The XB240H supports G-Sync, which was not so good compared to the BenQ XL2420G – the Acer monitor scored 12 out of 20, while the BenQ XL2420G scored 14, which is a difference of 10%. Also with maximum brightness of 269.3 nits only and just the Display Port (DP) for connectivity it didn't really win any performance or feature related honors in this comparison review. Nothing horribly wrong with this monitor, it's just an average performer.

ABOVE ₹50K
BenQ XL2730Z, XR3501

The Xl2730Z is the higher priced of the BenQ XL series siblings, selling exactly at the ` 50k mark. It is FreeSync enabled meaning it will support sync with a compatible AMD GPU. Skipping this monitor's features and design highlights, we would talk directly about its performance prowess. This monitor is amongst the highest performers as far as all our synthetic benchmarks are concerned – Spyder, Lagom.nl LCD test, not to mention PixPerAn and other audio-video tests. What's more, in the FreeSync - GSync test parameters, this monitor outperforms all other GSync monitors and finishes second best in terms of gaming performance, trailing the ASUS MG279Q by a very narrow margin. It's a very good purchase at the price, one that we're only glad to recommend.

The BenQ XR3501, on the other hand, is the heaviest of all monitors. It sports a 35-inch screen. Huge would be an understatement, this monitor is quite intimidating to work on a day-to-day basis from a close range, purely because of its size. It has an AMVA panel as opposed to the mainstream TN or IPS panels, which is a good thing considering AMVA panels provide better black levels – the XR3501's black levels are the second best amongst all monitors tested in this comparison test. In terms of build quality, the height adjustment feature was sorely missed on this monitor. But comparing it to its competitors from Acer and ASUS, it would've benefited with built-in audio and height adjustment feature given the fact that it's such a huge display in size.

LG

If you are not a big fan of curved displays, but want to have a ultrawide resolution supported panel then you might want to consider LG 34UM67. But let us warn you that the display is so wide that it literally hurts to look from one end to another. It is also one of the only two displays sporting an IPS panel in this comparison. It comes with a customizable joystick at its bottom screen bezel, useful to switch through all its onscreen menu items. While some of the monitors also had joystick OSD controllers, they were not as customizable as the LG's. But, the thing which we missed the most was the unavailability of display adjustments, especially height customization – an important feature in such a large panel. On the performance front, the LG FreeSync enabled monitor trailed the Acer and ASUS on core gaming performance, but it shined through some of the other multimedia video tests we conducted through our benchmarks and tests.

Acer XR341CK

The Acer XR341CK is a 34-inch huge curved display with the highest brightness of 340.4 nits & supports VESA Adaptive Sync and AMD FreeSync. This was the first monitor we unboxed in the test centre when

Acer XR341CK